WHEELER
FOOD SAFETY SERVICES

Metal Detector Verification Log

Routine operator checks for a metal detector critical control point (CCP)

Company / site: _____ Line / detector ID: _____ Make / model / serial: _____ Week of / page: _____

Ferrous test piece: ___ mm · cert # _____ Non-ferrous: ___ mm · cert # _____ Stainless steel: ___ mm · cert # _____ Check frequency (per plan): _____

Date	Time	Check (S / R / C / E / M)	Product / program #	Detected & rejected? (✓ / ✗)			Reject bin locked?	Fail-safe alarm OK?	Result P / F	Corrective action (ref # if failed)	Operator initials	Verified by (QA / supv.)
				Fe	Non-Fe	SS						

If any check fails: stop the line · hold all product made since the last successful check · notify QA · find and fix the cause · repeat the full check until it passes · re-inspect the held product through a working detector · record the corrective action and reference it above.

Check codes: S = start-up · R = routine (during production) · C = product changeover · E = end of shift · M = after maintenance or adjustment. ✓ = detected *and* rejected into the bin; ✗ = missed or not rejected.

wheelerfs.com · (385) 201-5609 · info@wheelerfs.com

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How to Run a Metal Detector Verification

A plant guide for operators and QA. Follow your own food safety plan where it differs.

Before you start

- Use the **certified test pieces** named in your food safety plan: ferrous, non-ferrous, and stainless steel, at the sizes on this log.
- Inspect each test piece. Replace any that are **cracked, worn, or unreadable**; a damaged piece may not match its labeled size.
- Confirm the detector is running the **correct product program** for what's on the line.
- Check out the test pieces from their secure storage, and return them when you're done.

How to run the check

1. **Run each test piece with product**, in or on a pack, not on an empty belt, so product effect is included.
2. Place it where detection is hardest: the **center of the aperture**. Many plants also test the **leading and trailing edges** of the product.
3. Run **ferrous, then non-ferrous, then stainless steel**, one at a time, at normal line speed.
4. Each one must be **detected and rejected**: watch the reject device fire and confirm the pack lands in the **reject bin**.
5. Check the **reject bin is locked** and the reject confirmation and alarms work.
6. **Retrieve the test pieces** from the bin and count them back. Never leave a test piece in product.
7. Record the result on the log and initial it.

When to check

- **Start-up**, before any product is released
- **During production**, at the interval in your plan (many plants check every 1–2 hours)
- **Product or program changeover**
- **After maintenance**, adjustment, or any stoppage
- **End of shift or run**, so the last product made is covered

The interval decides how much product you must hold if a check fails. Shorter intervals mean less product at risk.

If a check fails

1. **Stop the line** and tell QA or your supervisor right away.
2. **Hold all product** made since the last successful check.
3. **Find and fix the cause.** Don't just lower the sensitivity.
4. **Repeat the full check** until every test piece passes.
5. **Re-inspect the held product** through a working detector.
6. **Record the corrective action** and what happened to the held product.

Verification vs. validation

Verification (this log) shows the detector is working right now. **Validation** proves it finds and rejects your specified test pieces in every product, with every fail-safe tested, at least once a year. QA should review and sign these logs regularly.

Need a validation? Wheeler Food Safety validates metal detectors and X-ray systems for food plants across Utah:
wheelerfs.com · (385) 201-5609.

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